

How the KLGA Adaptive Test Works

Karen Language Growth Assessment (KLGA) - Teacher & Administrator Reference

1. Purpose of the Adaptive Test

The KLGA Adaptive Test is designed to find the highest level of Karen reading and sound-building skills a student can demonstrate while also collecting enough information to measure growth and identify instructional needs.

Every adaptive benchmark contains 40 questions. The difficulty changes during the test based on the student's performance, but the total test length stays the same.

2. KLGA Question Bank

The current KLGA system includes a **905-question question bank**. The adaptive test selects questions from this larger bank instead of giving every student the same fixed set of items.

A large question bank helps KLGA vary the questions students receive, reduce repeated items, support different adaptive paths, and make retakes less predictable. The system also tries to avoid repeating a question during the same test when unused items are available.

Important: The 905-question bank is the content source for the assessment. A student does **not** answer all 905 questions. In the adaptive benchmark, each student answers 40 questions selected from the bank according to the adaptive path.

3. The Five KLGA Levels

Level	Name	Main Skills
1	Foundations	Alphabet Recognition, Letter Sounds, Vowel Recognition
2	Sound Building	Alphabet + Vowel, Tone Recognition, Blend Sound Recognition
3	Blend Reading	Alphabet + Blend
4	Advanced Sound Building	Alphabet + Blend + Vowel
5	Phrase Reading	Karen phrase reading

4. Where the Test Starts

The adaptive benchmark begins at **Level 2 - Sound Building**. Level 2 is used as a practical middle starting point. The student's performance then determines whether KLGA moves to a harder level, an easier level, or continues collecting evidence around the student's likely placement.

5. The 75% Benchmark

KLGA currently uses **75% accuracy** as the level benchmark. When a tested level is at or above 75%, KLGA treats that level as passed. When the score is below 75%, KLGA treats that level as not yet passed.

Level Result	What KLGA Does
75% or higher	Moves upward when possible, or continues testing near the student's upper boundary.
Below 75%	Moves downward when necessary, or continues testing around the boundary between a passed and unpassed level.

6. The Adaptive Path

The test does not give every student the same sequence of levels. It uses the student's results to choose the next level. The goal is to locate the student's instructional boundary - the point between skills the student can demonstrate and skills that are not yet consistently demonstrated.

Example Step	Student Performance	Next Move
Starts at Level 2	Scores 89%	Move to Level 3
Level 3	Scores 75%	Move to Level 4
Level 4	Scores 50%	Likely placement boundary is between Levels 3 and 4
Remaining questions	More evidence is collected near the boundary	Strengthens placement, KGS, and skill information

7. Why the Test Still Continues to 40 Questions

KLGA does not stop immediately after it finds a likely placement. The remaining questions provide additional evidence around the student's current level and the next harder level. This helps reduce the effect of lucky guesses and gives the system more information for growth and skill diagnostics.

Important: The adaptive system is not simply trying to maximize the student's percentage. Harder questions are intentionally used to find the student's ceiling.

8. How Final Placement Is Determined

At the end of the 40 questions, KLGA recalculates performance for every level that was actually tested. The final placement is the **highest tested level that met the 75% benchmark**.

If Level 1 is tested and the student does not meet the Level 1 benchmark, the placement is reported as **Below Level 1**.

9. Four Different Pieces of the Result

Result	Purpose
Placement Level	The student's primary instructional proficiency result.
KLGA Growth Score (KGS)	A 0-599 internal score used to show progress within and across KLGA levels over time.
Overall %	Total correct answers divided by total questions answered. For the adaptive benchmark: correct answers / 40 x 100.
Skill Diagnostics	Percent correct for the individual skill areas actually tested.

Why Overall % Can Be Lower Than 75%

A student may pass Level 3 and then receive harder Level 4 questions that lower the total percentage. For example, a student could finish with 72% overall but still be placed at Level 3 because Level 3 met the 75% benchmark and Level 4 did not. Therefore, Overall % is a general accuracy statistic - it is not the adaptive placement score.

10. How KGS Fits Into the Adaptive System

Placement tells the teacher the student's current level. KGS adds information about **where the student is inside that level band**, especially by using performance on the next harder level.

Placement	KGS Range
Below Level 1	0-99
Level 1	100-199
Level 2	200-299
Level 3	300-399
Level 4	400-499
Level 5	500-599

11. Live Session Controls

During a teacher-created session, KLGA saves student progress to Firebase so the test can be managed in real time and resumed later.

Teacher Action / System Event	What Happens
End whole session	Active student tests stop and their progress is saved.
End one student's test	Only that student stops; their progress remains available to resume.
Terminate & Restart	The student's in-progress attempt is cleared so the next approved attempt starts at Question 1.
Resume later	The saved adaptive state, question order, responses, and progress are restored for the same session.

12. Automatic Speed Review

KLGA also monitors response pace during a session. This is a teacher review safeguard, not a cheating determination.

A student is automatically paused for **Speed Review** only after a sustained pattern: at least 8 questions answered, at least 6 of the latest 8 answered in under 2.5 seconds, and an average response time under 3.0 seconds across those 8 questions.

When a Speed Review is triggered, the student's progress is saved and the teacher chooses either **Resume Test** or **Restart from Question 1**. Resuming resets the recent pace window so the student is evaluated on a fresh pattern.

13. Important Interpretation Notes

Use Placement Level	for the student's primary proficiency / instructional level.
Use KGS	for longitudinal growth within and across levels.
Use Skill Diagnostics	to identify what to teach, reteach, or extend.
Use Overall %	as a general accuracy snapshot, not as a pass/fail grade.

Technical note: KLGA's current adaptive routing is a rule-based instructional measurement system. It is not yet a psychometrically calibrated IRT, Rasch, or NWEA MAP-style CAT. KGS is an internal KLGA growth indicator, not a RIT score.